

State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security

A data-forward view of page size, request patterns, protocol adoption, encryption, and CSS font loading practice across January 2020–March 2026.

DATA SOURCE

HTTP

Archive
State of the Web report

AUDIENCE

Perf Eng

Front-end architects

WINDOW

2020–2026

Jan 2020 to Mar 2026

Crawl Sample Size Tripled: From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



DESKTOP CRAWL

~16M

URLs after stabilizing by mid-2023 onward

MOBILE CRAWL

~12.5M

URLs after the mid-2022 step change

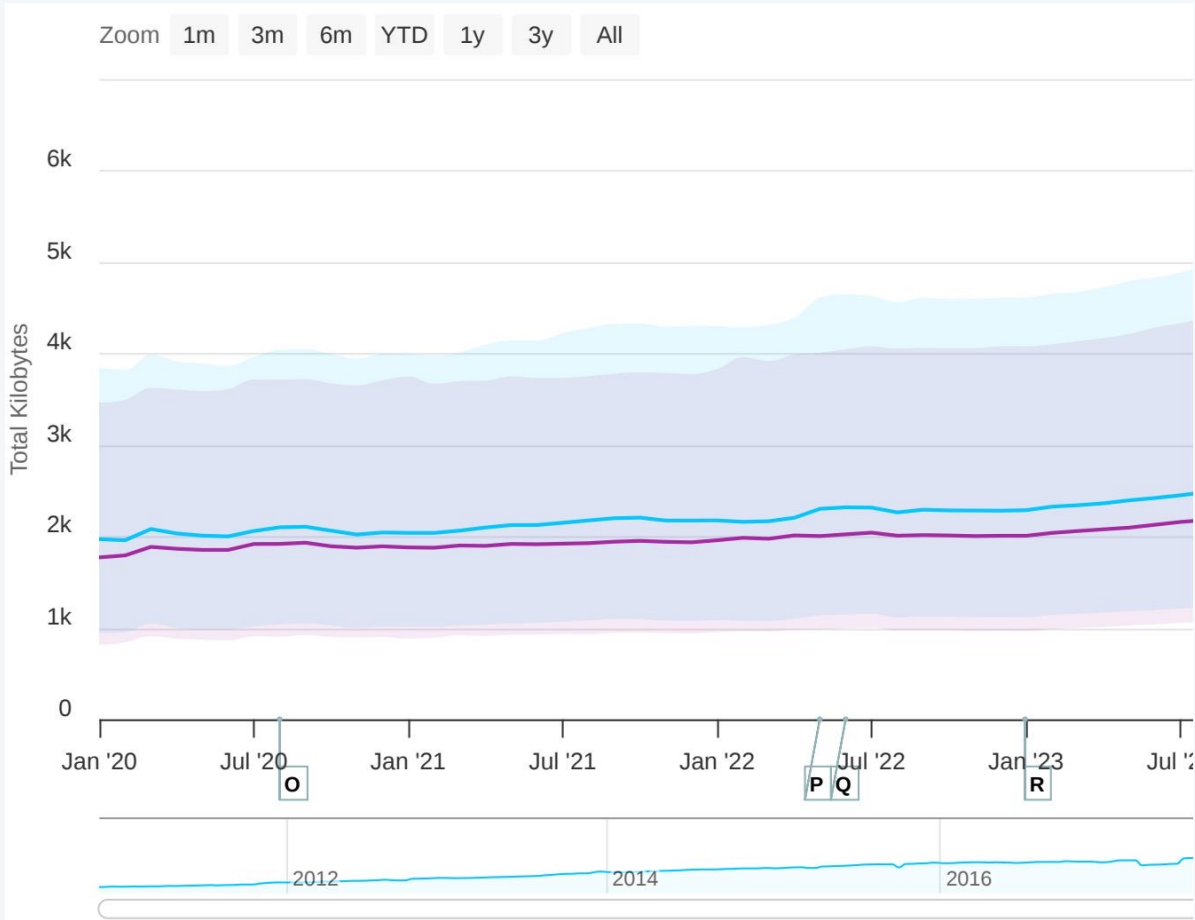
January 2020 baseline: desktop ~5M URLs; mobile ~3.5M URLs.

Mid-2022 jump: desktop ~15M and mobile ~10M URLs.

Larger crawl scale improves macro-trend visibility, but trend breaks around expansion points deserve interpretation.

Source: HTTP Archive State of the Web sample-size time series; values cited from source brief.

Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily to ~2,000 KB on Desktop



DESKTOP MEDIAN

~2,000 KB

Up from ~1,600 KB in early 2020 (▲ ~25%)

MOBILE MEDIAN

~1,900 KB

Tracks slightly below desktop (▲ ~25%)

Long-tail signal

The 75th-percentile desktop page exceeds 4,000 KB, showing persistent variance and heavy-page risk beyond the median.

Source: HTTP Archive total kilobytes time series with IQR bands; table values cited from source brief.

76 Requests per Desktop Page While TCP Connections Drop to 12

DESKTOP REQUESTS

76

Median resources per page; ▲
2.7% over the period

MOBILE REQUESTS

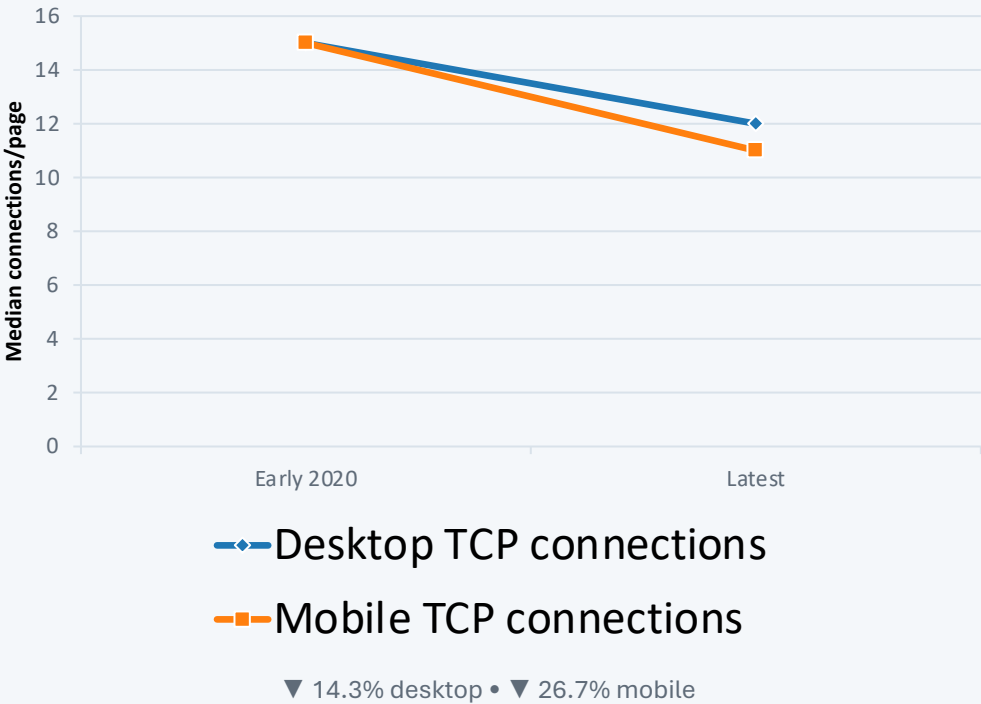
71

Median resources per page; ▲
2.9% over the period

Interpretation

Request counts are edging up, but fewer TCP connections indicate that HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 multiplexing is improving transport efficiency.

Median connections fell from about 15 in early 2020 to 12 desktop / 11 mobile.



Source: HTTP Archive request and TCP connection metrics; endpoint values cited from source brief.

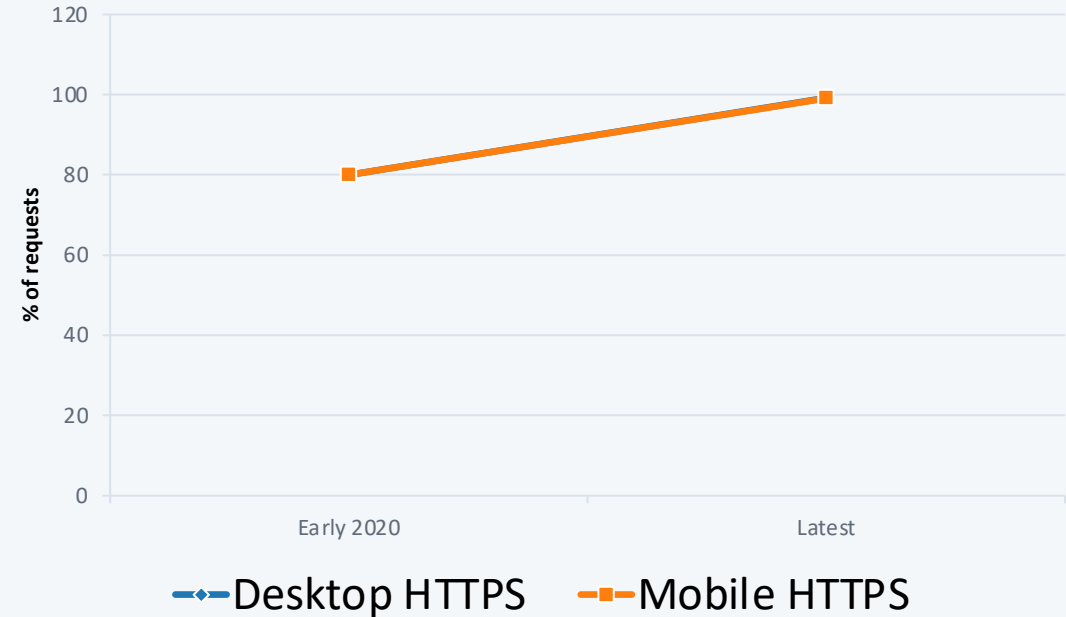
HTTPS Requests Reach 99%: Encryption Is Now the Default

HTTPS REQUESTS

99%+

99.2% desktop
99.1% mobile

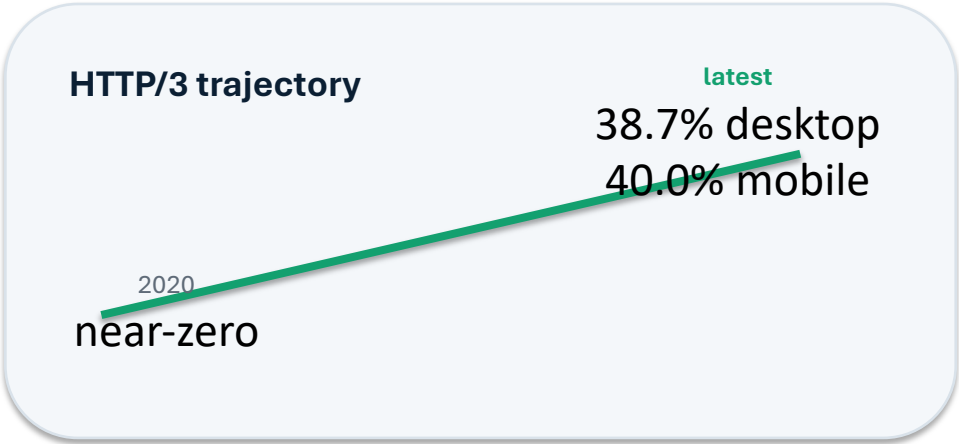
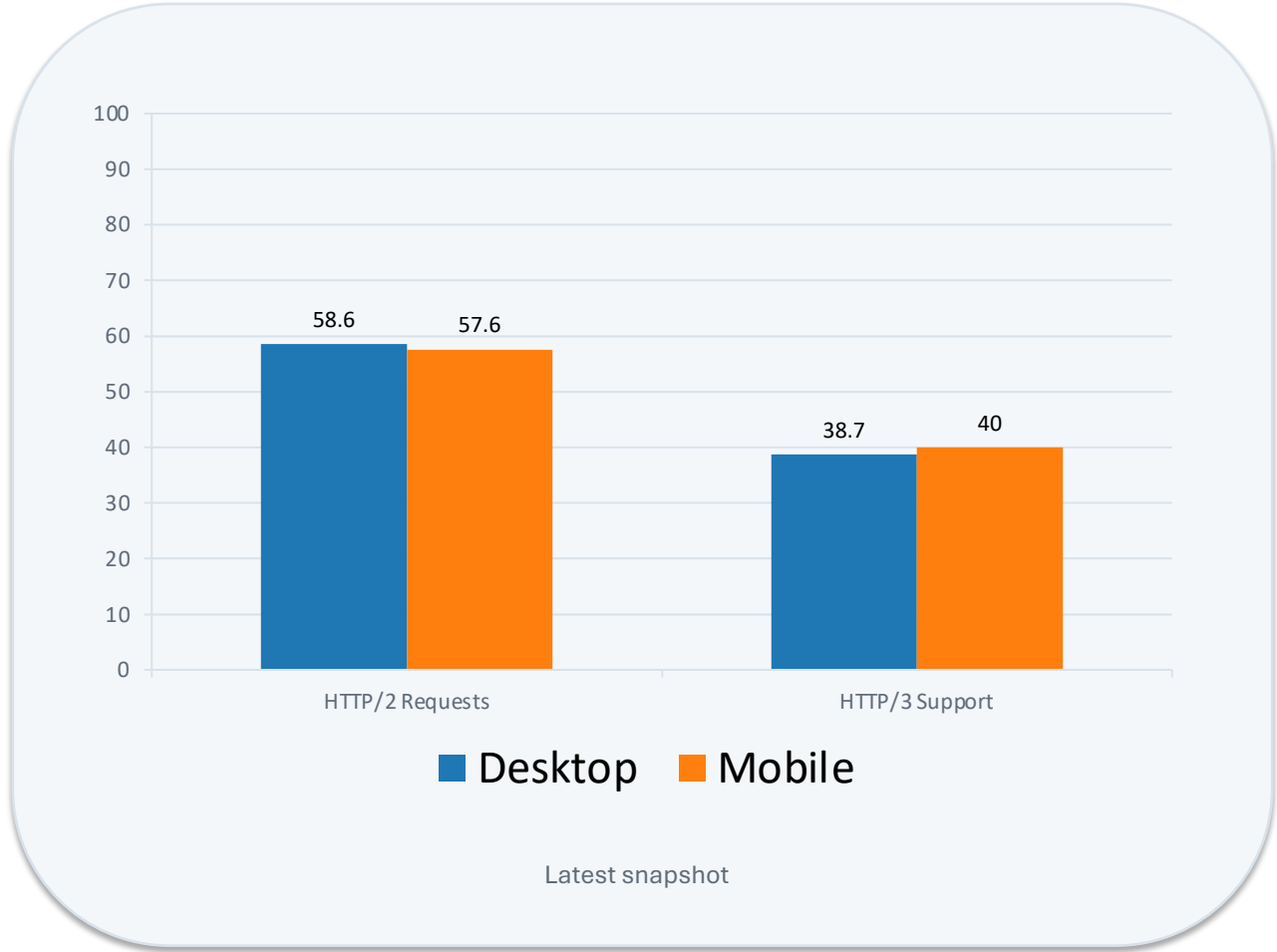
Plaintext HTTP is effectively gone on the modern web.



Adoption rose from around 80% to 99%+, a gain of roughly 19–20 percentage points.

Source: HTTP Archive HTTPS adoption metrics; source brief states ~80% early-2020 and 99.2% desktop / 99.1% mobile latest.

HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Support Surges to 40%

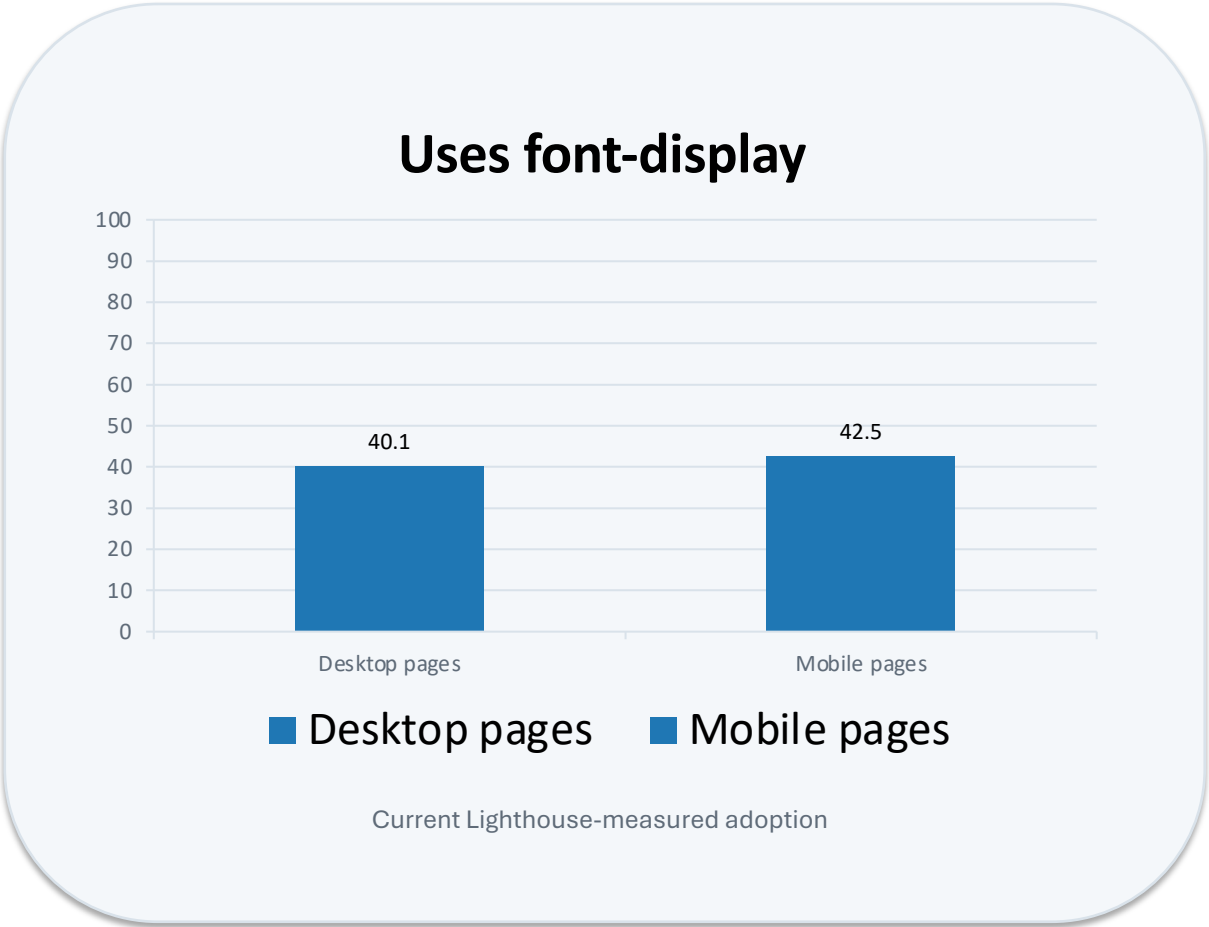


Measurement caveat

HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 support rather than actual usage because fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc headers.

Source: HTTP Archive protocol table and HTTP/3 support note from source brief.

Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile, Up 61% Since 2020



DESKTOP

40.1%

Up 14.9% since 2020

MOBILE

42.5%

Up 61.0% since 2020

Why it matters

`font-display` helps avoid Flash of Invisible Text during web font loading, yet more than half of pages still risk FOIT.

Source: HTTP Archive / Lighthouse font-display adoption values from source brief.

Key Takeaways: Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

1

Page weight keeps climbing

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020.

2

HTTPS is the baseline

99%+ of requests use HTTPS; unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct.

3

HTTP/3 is the fastest grower

Support moved from near-zero to ~40%, while HTTP/2 remains ~58–59%.

4

Connections are declining

Multiplexing has cut median TCP connections by 14.3% desktop and 26.7% mobile.

5

Font-display remains an opportunity

Adoption is ~40–42%, leaving more than half of pages exposed to FOIT risk.

Benchmark your own sites against these baselines: page weight, request count, TCP connections, HTTPS coverage, HTTP/3 support, and `font-display` usage.

Source: synthesized from HTTP Archive key findings in source brief.